This time I make sure not to shush her. We have all learned our lessons there. Ruby is born at eight o'clock the following morning. I take Lola in to meet her sister, the sister that Daniella said she wanted the moment she had Lola, then drive them all home. The family that I only have a moment with – the four of us who will become so united – is going to shape not only my life, but my cricket in positive ways that I cannot even dare to foresee here. They are going to teach me that cricket is not the only thing in the world for me to live for, and this in turn is going to help teach me to not grip it as tight, to let it flow through me, let it be whatever it is. Thirty-six hours after arriving home, I am on a flight back to Australia to recommence the Ashes.

I have a punch of guilt on leaving Daniella with the girls at home, but an away Ashes series is particularly helpful company for sleepless nights with children. When I am back in Australia, bowling through the night, it's as if they are with me too, I can sense them all receiving the hyper-green and bright glare from the television sets that light up cricket-loving homes throughout the winter nights in England.